

All roads LEAD TO Rome

As competing city-states, Florence and Milan often found themselves in a tug-of-war over which was the most important and powerful.

In the early 1500s, however, the two rivals found something new to compete over. That “something” was Leonardo.

Palazzo Vecchio,
Florence

While working on the *Mona Lisa*, Leonardo had accepted a new commission to create a large mural in Palazzo Vecchio, the town hall of Florence. It was to show the Battle of Anghiari in 1440, when Florence and its allies defeated Milan. This victory had made Florence the dominant power in central Italy.

